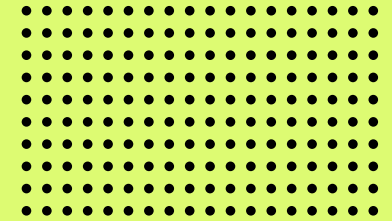


Lawhive • Hackathon 2026



PROBLEM PACK / V.02

PROBLEM TRACKS

FIVE STARTING POINTS FOR AI-NATIVE LEGAL WORK

V. 02

LONDON 30/05/26

FRESH READ



Descriptive, not prescriptive



A note before you start

Lawhive Hackathon London 2026 - Saturday 30 May

ABOUT LAWHIVE

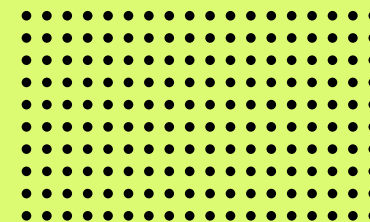
Lawhive is an AI-native legal operating system — a fully online firm built around the idea that most consumer legal work shouldn't look the way it traditionally has. We've rebuilt large parts of how consumer legal gets delivered, and we're constantly building more.

But the work is far from done. We've spent the last few weeks asking Lawhive's lawyers what they see across the wider market — the small, unglamorous frictions that decide whether a person in trouble gets help or doesn't, and the places where even the best of what exists today still leaves real room on the table. The framings below are written from their answers, and from the problems we're actively wrestling with ourselves.

These aren't briefs in the corporate sense. They're a description of where consumer legal work breaks down today, with the specifics that matter — and an invitation to imagine the version of each of these that doesn't exist yet. You don't have to solve every dimension we've laid out. Pick the one that feels most alive to you and build something that makes us see the problem in a new way.

"We're not judging on polish. We're looking for a real problem clearly understood, a working prototype, a clear argument for why your approach moves the needle on access to justice, and the potential to go further."

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PROBLEM TRACK / FRESH

TRACK A

OPEN BRIEF

V. 02

LONDON 30/05/26

FRESH



THE HOOK

What if the biggest leap forward for access to justice is something we haven't imagined yet?



Open Brief

What if the biggest leap forward for access to justice is something we haven't imagined yet?

WHAT'S ACTUALLY GOING ON

The other four briefs are starting points, not a complete list. We've framed them around the parts of the journey where Lawhive's lawyers see the most friction across consumer legal — but our perspective, even as an AI-native firm operating across the whole stack, is still shaped by the problems closest to what we already do.

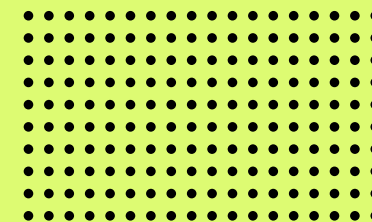
If you've come in with a sharper instinct for where the leverage really is — a different stage of the journey, a different kind of user, a different question entirely — we genuinely want to see it. Make the case for why your problem matters more than ours. Show us what we're missing.

The same standards apply: a real problem clearly understood, a working prototype, a clear point of view on access to justice, and a sense of where it could go with six more months.

A QUESTION TO SIT WITH

If you can make a case for a problem outside the four briefs that better captures where the leverage actually is, what is it — and why?

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PROBLEM TRACK / FRESH

TRACK B

KNOW YOUR RIGHTS

V. 02

LONDON 30/05/26

FRESH



THE HOOK

What if finding out your legal rights was as easy as texting a friend?



Know Your Rights

What if finding out your legal rights was as easy as texting a friend?

WHAT'S ACTUALLY GOING ON

Most consumers approaching a legal problem — anywhere in the market, not just here — carry a wildly distorted picture of what pursuing a claim actually looks like. They underestimate the cost. They underestimate the time. They underestimate how much evidence they'll need to produce, and they underestimate how much of the process happens before anything reaches a court at all.

Our lawyers see the same pattern over and over: someone arrives certain they have a strong case, and the first conversation isn't legal analysis — it's recalibration. The pre-issue steps. The waiting times. The obligation to give the other side reasonable time before acting. The expense of suing someone. The emotional toll of a year of back-and-forth. The gap between expectation and reality is the single biggest source of friction at the start of any matter.

There's a second misconception underneath the first. People think their account of what happened is enough. The reality is harder: we may believe you, but a judge will need hard evidence — and even then it's at their discretion.

WHAT CONSUMERS TEND NOT TO REALISE

- The journey to court is mostly the bit before court — and the bit before court is mostly waiting
- The cost of bringing a claim can exceed what you're claiming for
- Your version of events isn't a claim until it's evidenced
- A judge can believe you and still rule against you
- Losing has consequences beyond not winning — costs orders, time, the mental toll of having lived inside the dispute

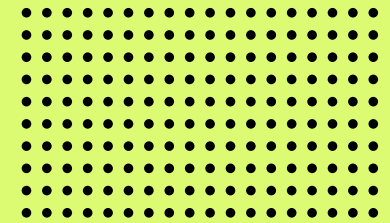
DIMENSIONS WORTH THINKING ABOUT

- 01 How do you give someone a clear-eyed picture of what they're about to walk into — without scaring off the people who genuinely have a strong case?
- 02 How do you separate a complaint that has legal standing from one that's just a complaint?
- 03 Plain-English next steps are easy to draft and hard to draft responsibly. What does it look like to give specific guidance without straying into "this is legal advice"?
- 04 What does a prospects assessment look like for a non-lawyer? A percentage? A traffic light? A narrative?

A QUESTION TO SIT WITH

If the most useful thing an agent could do is talk someone out of pursuing the wrong claim, what does success look like — and how would you measure it?

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PROBLEM TRACK / FRESH

TRACK C

CASE IN A BOX

V. 02

LONDON 30/05/26

FRESH



THE HOOK

What if getting legal help felt as seamless as booking an Uber?



Case In A Box

What if getting legal help felt as seamless as booking an Uber?

WHAT'S ACTUALLY GOING ON

The intake forms most legal services still use are, in our lawyers' words, "very open-ended" — broad questions that blanket-apply to every kind of case. The result, across the wider market, is that lawyers receive basic, vague information at the first contact, can't assess merit from the outset, and have to do a second, much deeper review once the client has been pushed for more detail.

It's a problem we're acutely aware of and actively building against — intake is one of the areas where the gap between what's possible with AI and what most legal services actually deliver is widest, and we have a lot of thinking and work going into it. The intake gap isn't fundamentally a UX problem; it's a structural one. A good intake for a tenancy dispute looks nothing like a good intake for faulty goods, which looks nothing like a good intake for an employment matter.

What our lawyers say they actually want is sharper case-type recognition early, then questions adapted to that case type with real depth. For a tenancy matter they'd want the AST surfaced from the outset. For a breach of contract, the contract. Mandatory fields that could safely be built around — limitation periods, start of tenancy, when the breach occurred, what loss was incurred. Evidentiary documents requested upfront rather than chased afterwards.

WHERE STANDARD INTAKE FALLS SHORT

- Generic questions across all case types — no case-specific depth anywhere
- Documents requested after intake, not during — gaps in the story emerge late
- No early signal on case type, so no early signal on merit
- Client expectations aren't set during intake — they arrive at the lawyer conversation cold
- No structured handoff from "client describing their situation" to "lawyer working a case"

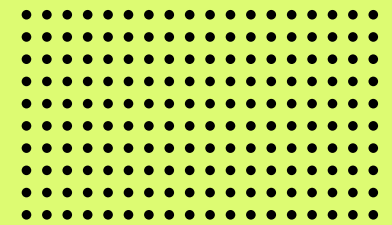
DIMENSIONS WORTH THINKING ABOUT

- 01 How early in a conversation can you reliably identify case type — and what do you do with the times you can't?
- 02 An adaptive form is more useful than a static one, but only if the adaptation feels natural to the user. What does that interaction look like?
- 03 Evidence collection is a UX problem as much as a legal one. How do you make someone want to upload the document, not dread it?
- 04 What does the output look like? A case brief is the obvious answer. Is it the best one?

A QUESTION TO SIT WITH

What's the smallest version of a "clean, verified case brief" that a lawyer would actually be glad to receive — and is that closer to a one-pager or a structured object?

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PROBLEM TRACK / FRESH

TRACK D

THE NEGOTIATOR

V. 02

LONDON 30/05/26

FRESH



THE HOOK

What if everyone had a tireless, expert negotiator in their pocket?



The Negotiator

What if everyone had a tireless, expert negotiator in their pocket?

WHAT'S ACTUALLY GOING ON

A surprising amount of consumer legal work never needs a lawyer if the pre-action phase is handled properly. The problem is that almost nobody handles it properly — because almost nobody knows what "properly" means.

Self-help users out in the wild — people trying to resolve a dispute without a lawyer at all — are largely unaware that pre-action requirements even exist. They don't know they have an obligation to try to settle before issuing a claim. They don't know they have to give the other side reasonable time to respond. They don't know that the rules for what a demand letter needs to contain are different depending on what kind of claim they're making. By the time many of them engage a firm, the damage is already partly done.

This is where the real compliance risk lives. If an AI drafts a Letter Before Action that follows the wrong protocol, the resulting LBA is non-compliant. That doesn't matter until proceedings are issued — at which point it becomes a serious problem. A non-compliant LBA isn't a typo. It's a wound that surfaces months later.

WHERE SELF-HELP USERS TEND TO DERAIL

- Acting before the pre-action protocol allows
- Skipping the demand-letter stage entirely
- Sending a demand letter that doesn't meet the protocol's requirements for their claim type
- Not tracking deadlines, or tracking the wrong ones
- Escalating when a settlement was within reach, or settling when escalation was the right move

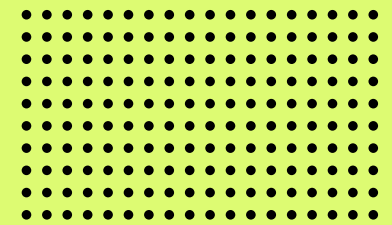
DIMENSIONS WORTH THINKING ABOUT

- 01 Different claim types, different protocols. How does an agent know which one it's in — and how does it gracefully ask the user when it doesn't?
- 02 Demand letters are negotiable instruments, not just legal documents. What changes if you treat them as part of a conversation rather than a one-off send?
- 03 The handoff from "AI is helping" to "you need a human lawyer now" is a moment of genuine judgement. What signals should trigger it?
- 04 A compliance-aware draft needs to request evidence, justify damages, and cite the right protocol. How do you do that without turning the experience into a procedural maze?

A QUESTION TO SIT WITH

If your agent does its job well, most users will never need to escalate. How do you build something whose best outcome is its own irrelevance?

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PROBLEM TRACK / FRESH

TRACK E

PAPERWORK CRUSHER

V. 02

LONDON 30/05/26

FRESH



THE HOOK

What if every dense contract instantly explained its own hidden traps?



Paperwork Crusher

What if every dense contract instantly explained its own hidden traps?

WHAT'S ACTUALLY GOING ON

Ask one of our lawyers about "hidden clauses" and you'll get a small correction: "There's no such thing as hidden clauses. Just impenetrable clauses." The problem isn't concealment — it's language. Legal documents are written in a way that makes them functionally invisible to the people they govern, and the vast majority of consumers sign them without ever engaging a lawyer to look first.

Leases are the running example. Especially leases for a leasehold purchase — outdated documents, complex sentence structures, dense reference to other documents, archaic phrasing. The person signing typically reads them once, doesn't understand them, and signs anyway because the alternative is not getting the flat. This happens millions of times a year across every kind of consumer contract.

There's a sharper distinction underneath. Not every scary-sounding clause is enforceable. Some look threatening but are unfair contract terms a court would never uphold. Others look benign but are the ones that will actually bite. Highlighting unenforceable clauses before signing is at least as important as flagging the enforceable ones. Deadlines matter too — the dates buried in agreements that turn into real consequences months later.

WHAT CONSUMERS ROUTINELY MISREAD

- Outdated, jargon-dense documents (leases above all)
- Clauses that look intimidating but aren't enforceable
- Clauses that look routine but have teeth
- Deadlines that don't surface until they've already passed
- Cross-references to other documents the reader doesn't have

DIMENSIONS WORTH THINKING ABOUT

- 01 Plain-English summaries are table stakes. What separates a summary that's accurate from one that's useful?
- 02 Some clauses matter to this user; others don't. How does an agent know which is which without knowing everything about the user's situation?
- 03 A timetable of deadlines extracted from a document is one of the most concretely valuable artefacts you could produce. What does it look like in a form a non-lawyer would actually act on?
- 04 When does an agent stop helping and say "please talk to a real person before you do this"?

A QUESTION TO SIT WITH

If your agent's job is to make the document legible, what's the version of that job where it also makes the user more confident in their own judgement about what they're reading — not just more dependent on the tool?

What you'll have to work with

SYNTHETIC CASE SCENARIOS

A set of realistic but entirely fabricated client situations, sitting at two different points on the journey:

Four "fresh" cases

A client at the start of their problem, before anything has gone wrong with how they're handling it. Deposit dispute, wedding photographer no-show, faulty car, flight delay. The situations a Know Your Rights or Case In A Box agent would be meeting at the door.

Six "messy" cases

A client whose self-help has already partially derailed. Gym debt, withheld wages, housing disrepair, builder dispute, unfair dismissal, failed small claim. These are the situations a Negotiator or Paperwork Crusher might be cleaning up after — where the gap between "what should have happened" and "what did happen" is most instructive.

Each comes with the documents you'd expect: tenancy agreements, email chains, court forms, GP letters. The mess is the point — it's what real consumer legal work actually looks like.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

We're not judging on polish. We're looking for:

- 01 **A real problem, clearly understood**
You've chosen something specific and can explain why it matters.
- 02 **A working prototype**
Something we can actually interact with, however rough.
- 03 **A point of view**
A clear argument for why your approach moves the needle on access to justice.
- 04 **Potential to go further**
What would this look like if you had six more months?

INFRASTRUCTURE

GCP environment and tooling provided. Details confirmed before the day.